SPIRITUALITY AND THE DRUM

"The world where there is nothing but the spirit of all things, this is the real world that is behind this one, and everything that we see here is somehow a shadow from that world."

JOHN G. NEIHARDT, BLACK ELK SPEAKS

Spirituality starts with a quickening, a sense of appreciation from within our consciousness. We all look out as observers from inside ourselves, filtering out—according to our past conditioning—experiences that we want to absorb. What you see is not necessarily, what I see.

The beat of the drum has a quickening effect, which is so basic in its relationship to the human organism that it unifies and brings together the consciousness of all who are in hearing range to listen. No matter what you are doing or thinking, when the drum begins to pound, you and I hear the same sound and it affects us in the same way, beckoning us to listen and pay attention.

Drumming connects you with you bones, your heartbeat, and your natural rhythms. The beat brings you down-to-earth, out of your head, into your feelings and your connection to the Earth Mother. The rhythmical beat pushes through the emotions, the intellect, and into the spirit, the most etheric part of our nature. Spirit intuitively recognizes the transporting qualities of the regular beat as it draws the spiritual awareness out of the mundane into safe ceremonies and rituals that have proved protective for the soul over eons. These ceremonies are sacred to the spirit of the people; with the drum, they draw the people together as one. Drumming can be used in the following situations:

- *The centering of the Sacred Directions ceremony that pulls in all of the spiritual qualities manifesting around and within our lives.*
- *The cleansing of the aura and our home space of negative spiritual energy.*
- *The projection of prayers for thanks or need with the drumbeat.*
- *To focus your meditation.*
- *To anchor your body through trance states.*
- *To dissolve negative emotions.*
- *To dislodge stuck spiritual energy in healing situations.*
- *To call up the spirits of plants, of those beyond the veil where mortal consciousness cannot visit, and in the angelic realms.*
- *To create a cohesive spiritual quality within a group, which draws all the participants together, in preparation for direction and spiritual ceremony.*
- *To just have a good time.*